

Title: Can someone review my understanding of top lane wave management? I wanna know what is incorrect or correct. If anything is wrong please correct it.

Score:

--- POST CONTENT ---

Minion Management Laning Notes for top lane V3 by Liyose

Last update : 21/9/2023

This should cover most scenarios in the laning phase.

Terms:

> Freezing:

You should freeze when:

you are stronger than your lane opponent, If their jungle is topside

\- You need 4 minions MINIMUM to freeze, you want the general rule to be have as many enemy minions on your side of the lane that's possible for you to handle.

You can freeze when the enemy is slow pushing to you, and then you stop their shove and tank their minions resulting in a freeze.

If all your all minions die in a freeze but there are still enemy minions that are alive, tank the minions

and wait for your next wave to arrive and continue the freeze.

Thin out melee minions when you can and leave casters since melee minions love to go under your tower.

> Slow Push:

You should slow push when:

You want to crash the wave or to get a minion advantage in trades, get trade windows while opponent is trading. You can slow push by only last hitting / hitting the minions less than your opponent.

A third wave crash into a recall is also called a cheater recall. This allows you to get an early item advantage and a good wave state (freeze) When you come back to lane.

> Fast push / 1 wave crash:

You should fast push when:

you are looking for a short roam, tower plating's, or harassment under tower, (Makes it harder for the enemy laner to CS under turret):

You can perform a fast push by having good wave clear like Irelia or Lux and focus mainly on damaging their wave and crashing it. This is more effective mid lane since its easier to crash due to the smaller lane.

Killing caster minions first is the fastest way to fast push.

> Shove:

When you push the wave as fast as you can.

Prioritizing a shove means to sacrifice health, mana and cooldowns.

You should shove when:

The wave is on their side (Your wave is susceptible to being frozen thus you want it to crash to get a slow push for them ASAP because it puts you in a safer lane position. It allows you to freeze the wave once the enemy wave stacks to your side).

\- Call the jungler to break the freeze if the wave is frozen (If your champion has bad wave clear)

\- After the shove and crash the wave if its being frozen by the enemy. It will slow push back to you.

\> Trimming:

You trim the when you think the wave is getting too big to freeze. When its not worth the resources to tank the minion wave.

\> Even Minion Rule:

Even minion rule happens when:

There is an even amount of minions on one side of the lane.

The rule is that if you have even minions on one side of the lane, it will push to the other side as a result of minion stacking.

\> Forcing an enemy slow push (and freeze):

If the wave ever resets and collides in the middle like the start of the game, if you stall their minions on their side, the even minion rule will apply and it will slow push towards you. Just last hit from then on. After their slow push, trim the wave if necessary and freeze.

> Zoning:

You zone when:

You have frozen wave AND you are CURRENTLY stronger than your opponent:

\- walk in front of the wave and pressure them off CS and EXP

> Winning team rule:

The team's minions who is winning will do slightly more damage and will push slightly faster.

--- TOP COMMENTS ---

[Comment 1 | Score: 8]

I think you could do with more thought about using proxying when you're behind. If you're 0/3 and the enemy laner gives you the opportunity while they're trying to freeze, you should go as far behind their turrets as you need to and just clear the wave, force them to trade your life for exp

instead of being able to just take you out of the game. [baus?s guide](<https://youtu.be/oAObDw9EjGU?si=kWh5JiVxf4Yxdwin>)

[Comment 2 | Score: 3]

So besides this proxy conversation we are having, anything else I should take away from this? Are my concept understandings correct?

[Comment 3 | Score: 2]

In top before opponent can os wave you never want to fast push except to recall right after (or get into the jungle for some reasons).

And before 14 min in top you never want to use any cd or resources (health, mana, tempo, xp, ?) anywhere else than top. There is just too much to lose for weakening yourself.

After theory you need to learn how to choose the best tactic case by case. For that you need to learn to learn.

After you use a tactic, reflect on your decision. What information did you have? Could you predict the result? How does it compare to what you believe would have happened with another tactic?

Players often struggle to make the jump from knowledge to tools. Mostly because they don?t know how to use tools:

Try the tool. Evaluate the result. Criticize the tool.

[Comment 4 | Score: 1]

In low master this feels too rigid, initial thoughts is that freezing is generally a good idea, you don?t have to be stronger. But if you?re far too weak theyre easily going to break it obviously. It?s usually more a weighing of your ability to shove out and reset or stay and deny a couple of minions of exp

from then if they reset, or safer csinf or setting up a gank. If you are only slightly weaker they might not even be able to break it due to having to respect jungle interference in a trade

Especially emphasis on this being too rigid. There aren't rules based on such simple factoring. It depends greatly on what champ you are and the matchup. I only play pantheon so my champ is god awful at shoving compared to most tanks or bruisers, but it's also easier to abuse poke closer to turrets. And it's very unsafe to be close to enemy turret unless both of us are low because panth all in is really bad on full hp (very poor long trades/all ins).

So he plays differently than say, perhaps Mordekaiser who needs to constantly uptime his shield so he always wants to shove pretty much, illaoi plays for tentacles and poke and can't freeze or chase (that) well anyway. Notice your rule set becomes useless when just bringing up a few champs and how they play, not even considering matchups. GP also dominates via barrel abuse but he can't do that from turret. Aarox however can both be early game menace with his poke or want to cower and scale safely under his turret vs dash champs like jax or riven. Or depending on the general game. Depending on what the jungles are both doing, your jgler being present top can mean either shoving hard or freezing, and same can be said if enemy is there and you just want to shove out rather than risk being dive while your jglers 3v2s bot. So many scenarios, a lot of it is learn by experience or adapt on the fly